



YOU ARE **7 WEEKS AND 2 DAYS**

229 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

Your baby won't look recognizably human yet, but the lower lip and jaw are formed; the upper lip is not yet complete, and the mouth appears very wide. The external ears are developing low down at the jaw line and the eyes are wide apart.

“Although your baby’s brain is still very simply formed, it’s undergoing some remarkable changes.”

This is a really important stage of development. The baby’s brain is a hollow structure, joined to the spinal cord, but it’s now starting to fold and form five distinct areas.

The lowest part, or hindbrain, is the first part to grow rapidly and will become structures known as the pons, medulla, and cerebellum. These structures are the most primitive areas of the brain and determine many basic actions that we do without conscious effort, such as breathing and keeping our balance.

Above this is the midbrain that conveys signals from the hindbrain, peripheral nerves, and spinal cord to the forebrain. This part of the brain consists of the thalamus —involved with emotions and sensory perception—and the two cerebral hemispheres. Each hemisphere has a fluid-filled chamber and within that the cerebrospinal fluid is produced.

At the 11–14 week scan (see [First ultrasound scan](#)), brain development checks will be carried out.